You can now delete the App.java and AppTest.java files, because you'll be writing new versions of these as we go.

2.1.4 Initializing the database

To get the API up and running you'll need a database to store the messages that users send to each other in a social space, as well as the metadata about each social space, such as who created it and what it is called. While a database is not essential for this example, most real-world APIs will use one to store data, and so we will use one here to demonstrate secure development when interacting with a database. The schema is very simple and shown in figure 2.2. It consists of just two entities – social spaces and messages. Spaces are stored in the `spaces` database table, along with the name of the space and the name of the owner who created it. Messages are stored in the `messages` table, with a reference to the space they are in, as well as the message content (as text), the name of the user who posted the message, and the time at which it was created.

